

A survey of medical students found that most believe the surgical specialty has its own clearly defined "masculine" subculture, and that to succeed as surgeons, individuals need to "adopt masculine characteristics." These beliefs best reflect which aspect of surgical medical education?

- ☐ A. Teacher expectancy [4%]
- ☐ B. Manifest functions [14%]
- ✓ ☒ C. Hidden curriculum [75%]
- ☐ D. Material culture [5%]

Correct

76% answered correctly

Explanation:

Formal vs. hidden curriculum	
Formal curriculum	Hidden curriculum
Explicit, official content taught through the educational system (eg, <i>algebra, physics, chemistry</i>)	Implicit, unofficial information conveyed through the educational system (eg, <i>"Boys are better at math than girls"</i>)

Social institutions (eg, family, religion) are enduring, organized systems that outline behavioral norms and fulfill a purpose in society. The **education system**, a social institution that meets society's need to transfer knowledge and skills, is composed of both a formal and a hidden curriculum.

The formal curriculum includes the explicit, official content taught to students (eg, how to solve algebra equations). The **hidden curriculum** includes the **implied, informal mechanisms** by which **certain values** and **behaviors** are **promoted**; for example, an algebra teacher who calls mainly on male students is reinforcing a stereotype that boys are better at math than girls.

Survey results indicating that the surgical specialty has a "masculine" subculture, such that "masculine characteristics" are needed for success, best reflect the *hidden curriculum* of surgical medical education.

(Choice A) Teacher expectancy occurs when a teacher's beliefs about a student (eg, "she is smart," "he is lazy") result in the student meeting those expectations (eg, excelling or performing poorly). This is thought to occur as a result of the teacher's behavior toward the student. The survey results do not reflect teacher expectancy.

(Choice B) Functionalism, a macro-sociological theory comparing society to a biological organism, contends that social institutions have manifest (intended) and latent (unintended) functions. The survey results reflect a *latent* (not manifest) aspect of surgical medical education.

(Choice D) Material culture refers to the physical items a group of people create, use, and/or interact with (eg, clothing, technology), whereas symbolic (nonmaterial) aspects of culture (eg, language, values) are intangible. The survey results reflect *symbolic* (not material) aspects of surgical subculture.

Educational objective:

The education system's hidden curriculum includes implied, informal mechanisms by which certain values and behaviors are reinforced, whereas the formal curriculum includes explicit, official content taught to students.

Time spent:0 sec
Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:401765
System:
Demographics and Social Structure